

After an appeal letter, your thank you letter is the most important piece of mail you will ever send. So why gloss over and not pay it any attention. This can be the key to the next ask. Do yourself a favor and give it the attention it deserves. It will reap rewards.

Thank You Letter Checklist

- ☐ Is it personalized (as in 'Dear Lisa' vs. 'Dear Friend')?
- ☐ Is the gift amount noted?
- ☐ Do you start with something other than 'Thank you for your gift of...'? Use an exciting lead.
- ☐ Do you tell the donor when and how they will next hear from you? i.e. Newsletter, Email etc
- ☐ If this is a repeat gift, do you also thank the donor for their:
 - a. Past generosity (and indicate all it has made possible)?
 - b. Continued contributions/support?
- ☐ Say something new or timely in the PS – offer videos online, a Yom Tov message, an upcoming opportunity to visit or meet you, etc.
- ☐ Include a contact number they can call if they have questions. You can add an e-mail, but not the generic 'info@yourorg.org'. Direct them to a warm body (ie a real person), please.
- ☐ Do you need to thank them for something specific? For example:
 - a. Membership renewal.
 - b. Holiday appeal.
 - c. Memorial gift.
 - d. Capital campaign (focus on all the good this new building/machine/wing will do).



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- ☐ Do you need to reference something specific? For example:
 - a. A gift you'll be sending.
 - b. A certificate or photo you've enclosed.
- ☐ Do you have a website? Mention it in the letter, with a simple call-for-action to drive them there. ('Keep up with all the ways you're helping XYZ at www.XYZ.org.')
- ☐ And remember to:
 - a. Keep the letter short (3-4 paragraphs plus a PS).
 - b. Add required tax-deductible language.
 - c. Share with them 'all your gift makes possible...'
- ☐ Use more 'you' than 'we' and 'our.'
- ☐ Say thank you more than once.
- ☐ Proof-read your letter:
 - a. Use spellcheck (but carefully).
 - b. Print the letter and read it out loud, word for word.
- ☐ If you can, hand-sign them all.
- ☐ Make sure your donation thank you does NOT include:
 - a. An additional 'ask'.
 - b. An upgrade to monthly giving or other program
 - c. A gift reply envelope (even if there is no ask). – this is debatable – people do both.

